StoryCast: Research Document

Information architecture, wireframes and high-fidelity mockups for an accessible media feature microsite.

1. Project summary

StoryCast is a three-page microsite that shares short audio and video stories from everyday communities. Its design goal is that every story can be heard, watched *and* read: captions and transcripts are part of the layout, not an add-on. The build uses semantic HTML5, Sass and vanilla JavaScript only.

2. Users and needs

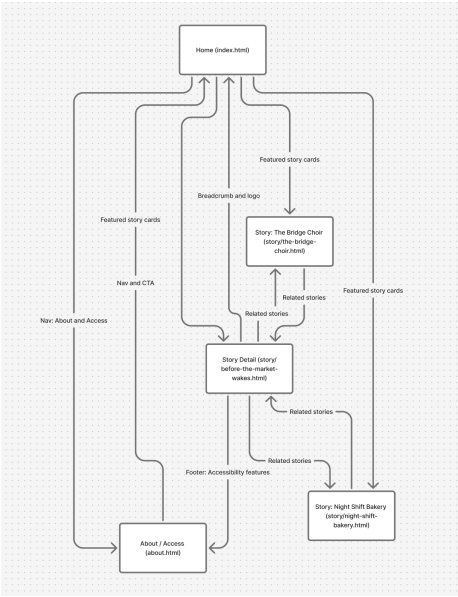
User	Need	Design response
Deaf or hard-of-hearing listener	Access to spoken content	Synced WebVTT captions on by default; full transcript on the page
Screen-reader user	Clear structure and labels	Landmarks, one h1 per page, labelled sections, aria-current
Keyboard-only user	Reach everything without a mouse	Skip link, logical tab order, high-visibility focus ring, button-based transcript seeking
Low-vision user	Readable text at any size	AA contrast, rem-based type and spacing, layout that survives 200% zoom
Mobile listener on a slow connection	Light pages, easy reading	No frameworks, small media files, responsive Grid/Flexbox layout

3. Information architecture

3.1 Sitemap

Three page types: Home, Story Detail (one page per story, all sharing one template) and About / Access. Primary navigation is on every page; Story pages add a breadcrumb and a

related-stories sidebar so users move between stories without returning home.



Editable sitemap (FigJam):

https://www.figma.com/board/AyzQPvLUD0G3KRdNnRmUJL/StoryCast-Sitemap

3.2 Content hierarchy per page

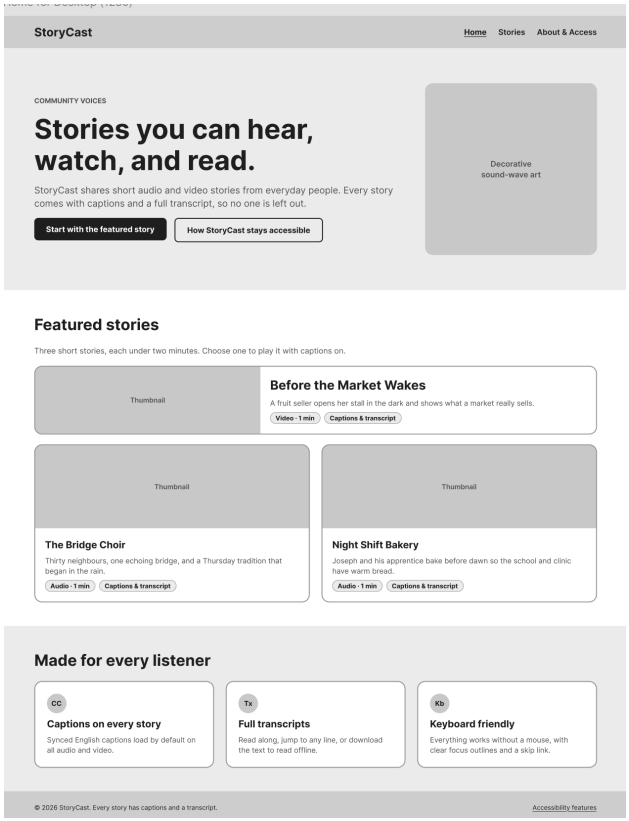
Page	Heading outline
Home	h1 Stories you can hear, watch, and read. → h2 Featured stories (h3 per story) → h2 Made for every listener (h3 per feature)
Story detail	h1 Story title → media figure with figcaption → h2 Transcript → aside h2 Related stories (h3 per card)
About / Access	h1 About StoryCast → h2 Our mission, Accessibility features (h3 per feature), How to engage, Known limitations

3.3 Navigation model

A three-item main nav (Home, Stories, About & Access) keeps the structure flat, so no menu toggle is needed and nothing is hidden behind JavaScript. The current page is marked with aria-current="page" and an underline, so it does not depend on colour.

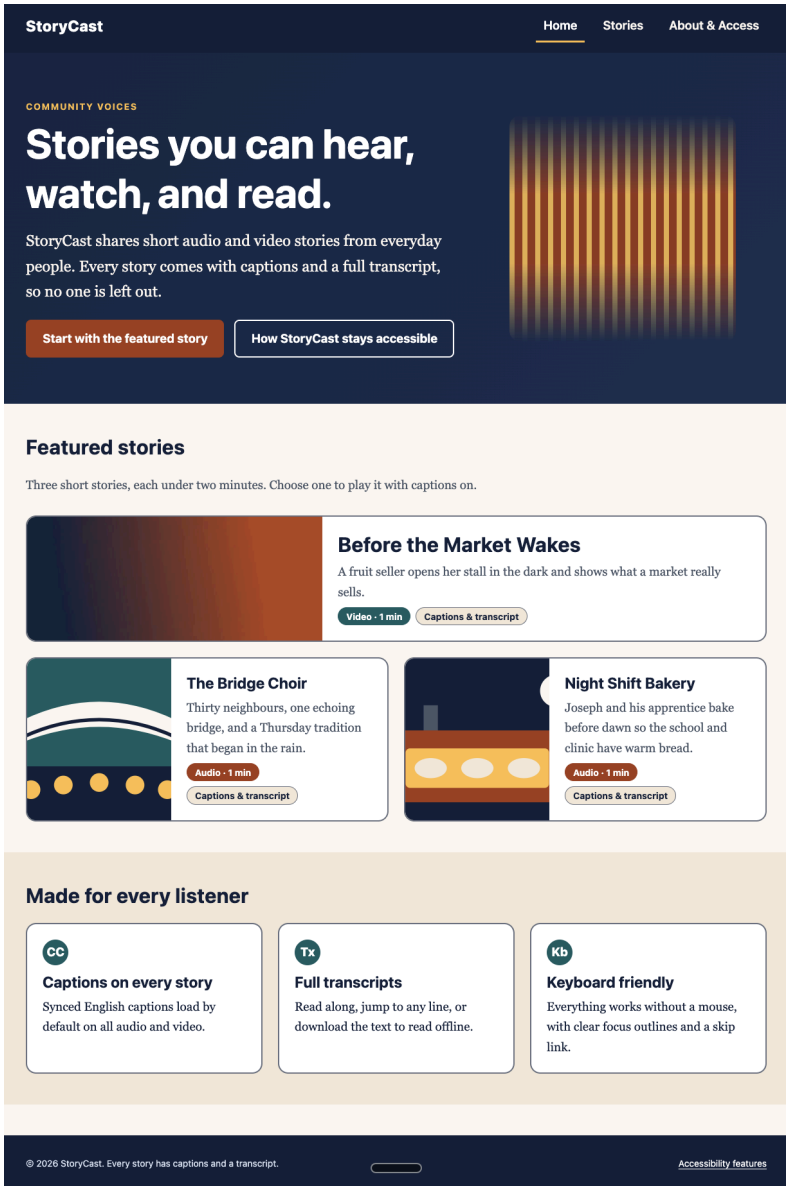
4. Wireframes

Low-fidelity wireframes fix layout and content priority before any colour or type decisions. Red notes in the Figma file call out behaviour such as the container query.



Wireframes (Figma, page “Wireframes”): https://www.figma.com/design/7BqGiKftWJIWfy6c5X2Y9V/StoryCast---Wireframes-and-Mockups (Home, Story, About, Home mobile)

5. High-fidelity mockups



Mockups (Figma, page “High-fidelity mockups”):

https://www.figma.com/design/7BqGiKftWJlWfy6c5X2Y9V/StoryCast---Wireframes-and-Mockups

Design decisions and reasoning

Decision	Reason
Warm cream background, deep navy text	15:1 contrast, comfortable for long reading, less glare than pure white

Decision	Reason
Terracotta accent (#a33a16)	Distinct brand colour that still reaches 6.3:1 on cream and 6.6:1 with white text
Serif body, sans-serif headings and UI	Serif suits storytelling; sans-serif makes controls and headings scan quickly. System fonts avoid extra requests
Transcript directly under the player	Equal prominence to the media; the transcript is part of the story, not a hidden extra
Cards whose layout depends on their own width	The same card works in the main grid, a wide featured slot and the narrow sidebar (container queries)
Badges that say “Video”, “Audio”, “Captions”	Text labels, so type and features are not conveyed by colour alone

6. Accessibility strategy (WCAG 2.1 AA)

Principle	Planned measures
Perceivable	Captions (1.2.2), transcripts (1.2.1), AA contrast (1.4.3), text resize and reflow (1.4.4, 1.4.10), non-text alternatives (1.1.1)
Operable	Keyboard access (2.1.1), skip link (2.4.1), page titles (2.4.2), visible focus (2.4.7), reduced motion
Understandable	lang on every page, consistent navigation (3.2.3), plain language
Robust	Valid semantic HTML, names/roles/states for custom controls (4.1.2)

7. Responsive plan

Technique	Where
CSS Grid	Page shell, auto-fit card and feature grids, story page (main + sidebar)
Flexbox	Header, nav, badges, footer, transcript header
Media queries	Hero two-column at 48rem, story sidebar at 64rem

Technique	Where
Container query	Media card: stacked by default, horizontal when its container is at least 30rem